

Relaxin Cabins — Platform User Manual

A complete guide to how the website works, what your guests can do, and what you can manage as the site owner.

1. What This Platform Is

Relaxin Cabins is a full booking website for your cabin rentals — similar in spirit to Airbnb or Vrbo, but built specifically for your property and branded entirely as your own. Guests can browse your cabins, check real-time availability, pay online, and manage their trip. You get a private admin area to manage rooms, bookings, guests, pricing, and see how the business is performing — all without needing a developer for day-to-day changes.

The site has two sides:

- **The guest-facing website** — what visitors and customers see and use.
 - **The admin dashboard** — a private area only you (and anyone you promote to admin) can access, for running the business.
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2. The Guest Experience

2.1 Homepage

The homepage is the first impression: a full-screen hero with your branding, a search bar to start a booking, trust badges (no booking fees, secure checkout, instant confirmation, 24/7 support), and a series of sections below it:

- **Featured cabins** — a curated preview of your top properties.
- **"The Full Relaxin Experience"** — a showcase of your property's unique perks (waterfront access, the entrance/welcome area, the slot gaming lounge) plus quick-glance amenities like the on-site ATM, sandy beach, and fire pits.
- **Amenities overview** — the comforts every guest can expect.
- **Photo gallery preview** — a taste of the full gallery.
- **Nearby attractions** — local things to do, with distance/drive-time, to help guests plan their stay.
- **Guest reviews** — real testimonials with star ratings.
- **FAQ** and a **contact form** for questions that come in directly from the site.

2.2 Browsing Cabins ("Explore")

The Explore page lists every cabin you've published, with:

- A live search box (search by cabin name as you type).
- Sorting: Default, Price (low→high or high→low), or Top Rated.
- A filter panel for narrowing by category and price range.
- Each cabin card shows its photo, name, rating, and nightly price at a glance.

2.3 Cabin Detail Page

Clicking into a cabin shows everything a guest needs to decide:

- A full photo gallery with a fullscreen lightbox viewer.
- Description, amenities (with icons), and bedroom/bathroom/guest-capacity details.
- Guest reviews and star ratings for that specific cabin.
- A "Save to Favorites" heart icon, so guests can shortlist cabins to come back to later.
- A booking widget showing price, a date picker, and a guest-count selector, leading straight into checkout.

2.4 Booking & Checkout

At checkout, the guest sees a clear price breakdown (nightly rate × nights, service fee, taxes, any discount) and chooses how to pay:

- **Pay in Full** — settle the entire stay now.
- **Half Now, Half Later (50%)** — pay a deposit today; the remaining balance can be paid securely online via a link emailed to them, or in person at check-in.

Payments are processed by **Stripe**, the same payment processor used by major travel and e-commerce platforms — guest card details never touch your server directly, which keeps the business well clear of card-data liability.

After paying, the guest lands on a **booking confirmation page** showing their booking ID, a status timeline (Confirmed → Check-in → Completed), the full price breakdown, and a "Contact Support" option. The page can also be printed for guests who want a paper copy.

2.5 Guest Accounts

Guests create an account with email/password (verified with a 6-digit emailed code) or sign in instantly with Google. Once signed in, they get a personal dashboard:

- **Overview** — upcoming trip countdown, quick stats (total bookings, favorites, completed stays), and recent booking activity.
- **My Bookings** — every past and upcoming booking, filterable by status, with the ability to cancel a pending/confirmed booking themselves.
- **Favorites** — every cabin they've saved.
- **Profile** — name and phone number.
- **Settings** — change display name, email, or password, and manage notification preferences.

2.6 Photo Gallery Page

A dedicated, editorial-style gallery page showcasing your property's best photography in a magazine-like grid, with a fullscreen viewer for browsing photo by photo.

2.7 Other Pages

- **About** — describes your different rental groups/styles (cabins, loft & luxe units, the loghouse).
- **Terms of Service** and **Privacy Policy** — standard legal pages.

3. Payments, Explained Simply

Guest pays...	What happens
Full amount	Card is charged in full at booking. Booking goes to "pending" for your review/approval, then "confirmed."
50% deposit	Card is charged for half at booking. The guest is emailed a secure link to pay the remaining balance online at any time before arrival — or they can simply bring cash/card at check-in instead. Either way, once the balance is paid, your records update automatically.

All charges, refunds, and balances are tracked automatically in the booking record — no manual bookkeeping needed.

4. Your Admin Dashboard

Everything below is only visible to you and anyone you've granted admin access.

4.1 Dashboard Home

A snapshot of the business: total bookings, total revenue, total rooms (and how many are currently available), total registered users, a monthly revenue chart, a breakdown of bookings by status, and a table of the most recent bookings.

4.2 Rooms

Create, edit, enable/disable, or delete each cabin listing. For each cabin you control:

- Title, description, nightly price, bedroom/bathroom count, max guests, category.
- Photos (multiple images per listing).
- Amenities — pick from a categorized list (kitchen, entertainment, outdoor, safety, views, etc.).
- Featured flag (to highlight it on the homepage), availability toggle, and a "Under Maintenance" flag for temporarily hiding a cabin without deleting it.

A cabin with active bookings can't be accidentally deleted — the system blocks it and tells you why.

4.3 Bookings

Every booking across the entire business, filterable by date range, searchable by booking ID or guest email. From here you can:

- **Approve** or **reject** pending bookings (with a custom reason sent to the guest).
- **Mark a booking refunded** after issuing a refund through Stripe.
- View full guest and payment details for any booking.

4.4 Users

A full list of everyone with an account:

- Search by name or email.
- Promote a user to **admin** (or remove admin access).
- **Block** a user (instantly prevents them from logging in) or unblock them.
- A "**Show Username/Email Table**" view for quickly scanning or copying a list of names and emails.
- A "**Download Excel**" button that exports the same list as a spreadsheet file — handy for mailing lists, guest records, or sharing with someone who isn't logged into the admin panel.

4.5 Coupons

Create discount codes for promotions — percentage-off or fixed-amount, with an optional minimum booking amount, a usage limit, and an expiry date. Toggle any coupon on or off without deleting it.

4.6 Gallery

Manage exactly which photos appear on the public Gallery page — upload new images, set a large/small display size, add captions, and remove outdated photos.

4.7 Nearby Attractions

Manage the "things to do nearby" list shown on the homepage — add a place, its distance, and approximate travel time from your property.

4.8 Analytics

A deeper look at performance: monthly revenue trends, your top-performing cabins, booking volume by category, and revenue broken down by booking status.

5. What Happens Automatically (No Action Needed)

The platform runs several things on its own, every day, with no one needing to click a button:

- **Booking confirmation emails** — sent the moment a payment succeeds.

- **Half-payment balance link** — automatically included in that confirmation email when a guest pays the 50% deposit option, so they can settle the rest online whenever they're ready.
 - **Stay-completed "thank you" emails** — every night, the system checks for any confirmed booking whose checkout date has passed, automatically marks it "completed," and sends the guest a thank-you email inviting them to leave a review.
 - **Admin new-booking alerts** — you're emailed automatically whenever a new booking comes in.
 - **Email verification codes** — sent automatically when a guest signs up with email/password.
 - **Password reset emails** — sent automatically when a guest forgets their password.
 - **Contact form messages** — submitted directly to your inbox the moment a visitor sends one.
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6. Feature Highlights

A few things worth knowing make this platform stand out:

- **Favorites/wishlist** — guests can save cabins and come back to them later.
 - **Verified reviews** — only guests can leave a rating and review, keeping feedback genuine.
 - **Secure payments** — handled entirely by Stripe, an industry-standard payment processor.
 - **Automatic status tracking** — bookings move through Pending → Confirmed → Completed (or Cancelled/Rejected) with the guest kept informed by email at every step.
 - **Mobile-friendly** — the entire site, including the admin dashboard, works cleanly on phones and tablets.
 - **Light & dark mode** — guests can choose their preferred look in their account settings.
 - **Spreadsheet exports** — guest contact lists can be pulled straight from the admin Users page.
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7. A Couple of Notes

- **Coupons** are fully built and ready to use, but the entry field is currently hidden from the checkout page. Let us know if/when you'd like promotional codes turned on for guests.
 - The **half-payment balance link** relies on a small Stripe configuration step (enabling one additional webhook event) — this is a one-time setup item on our end, not something you need to do.
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Questions about anything in this manual, or want a feature added or changed? Just ask — that's what we're here for.